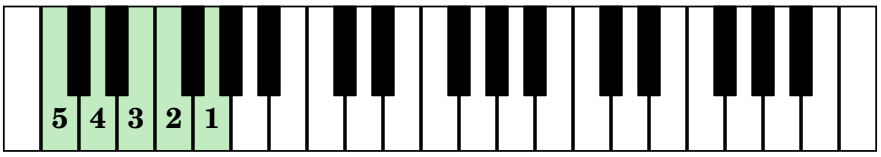
Unit 4

Low Notes and the Middle

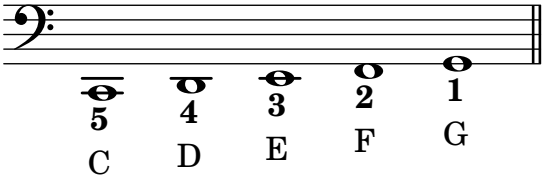
New: Ledger lines below the bass staff, down to C2; both hands near middle C

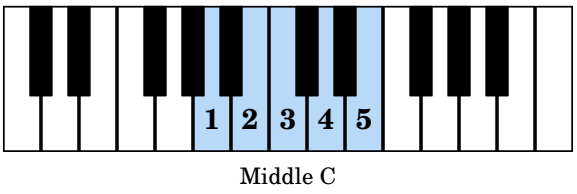
The bass staff ends at G on its bottom line; lower notes need ledger lines too. And between the two staves, around middle C, either hand can borrow ledger lines: the right hand reads notes below the treble staff, and the left hand reads notes above the bass staff. The same key can be written in either staff.



Left hand low C position: finger numbers on the keys

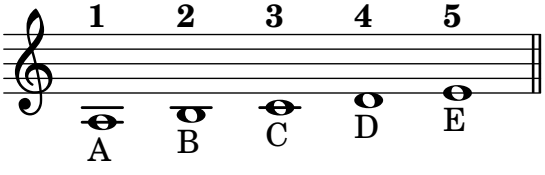
Your five notes

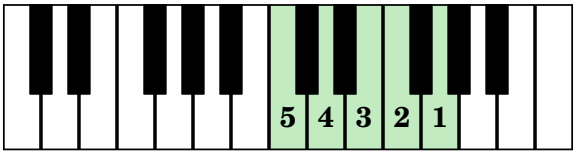




Right hand below middle C: finger numbers on the keys

Your five notes

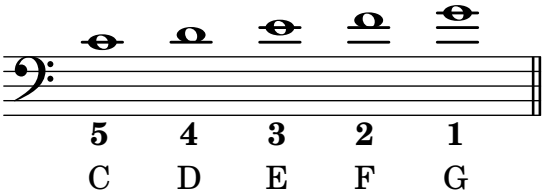




Middle C

Left hand above middle C: finger numbers on the keys

Your five notes



What is new

Ledger lines below

F2 sits just below the bass staff, E2 on its first ledger line, D2 below it and C2 on the second ledger line. Landmark: low C (C2) on two ledger lines.

Between the staves

Middle C has one ledger line in both clefs. In the treble staff, B3 hangs just below it and A3 sits on the second ledger line down. In the bass staff, D4 sits above middle C and E4 on the second ledger line up.

The tune in the bass

When the left hand has the tune, the right hand accompanies with short chords on the off-beats. Let the left hand sing and keep the right hand light.

Reading tips

1. Find the lowest note first and name it from low C or middle C.

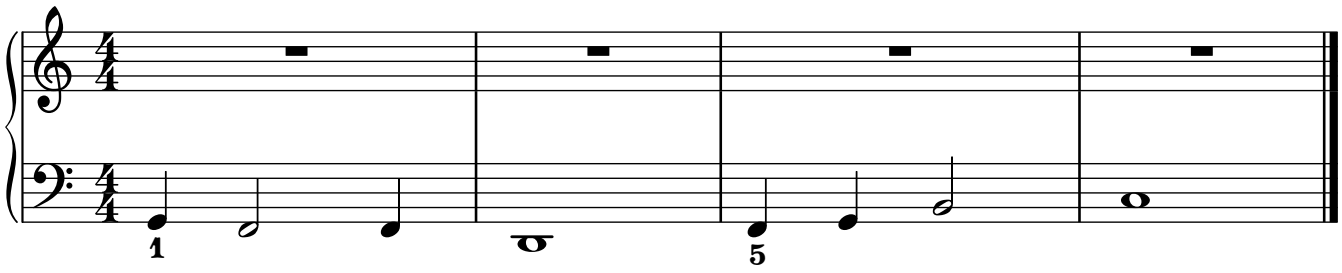
2. Near middle C, check which staff a note is in before you decide which hand plays it.

3. When the right hand plays after the beat, count out loud and let the left hand land on the beat.

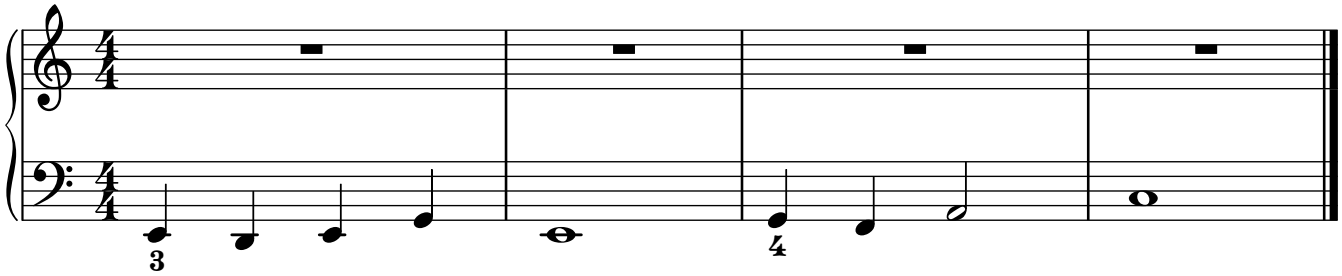
Part A: The left hand down low ♩= 60

The left hand down low: low C position (C2 to G2) and low F position (F2 to C3).

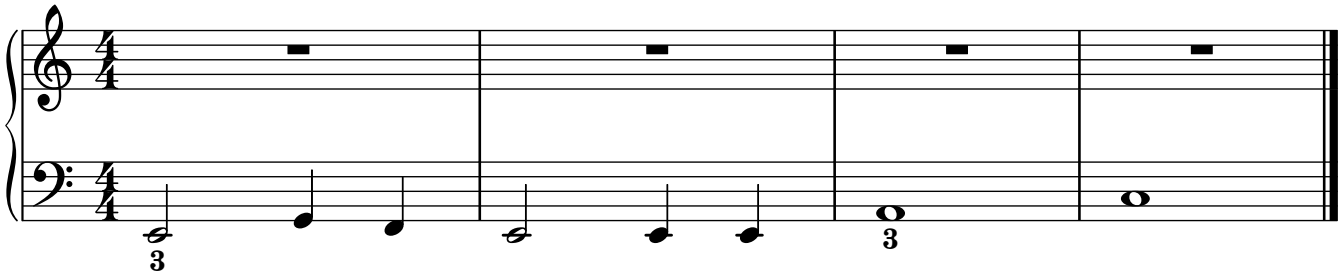
☐ **4.1**



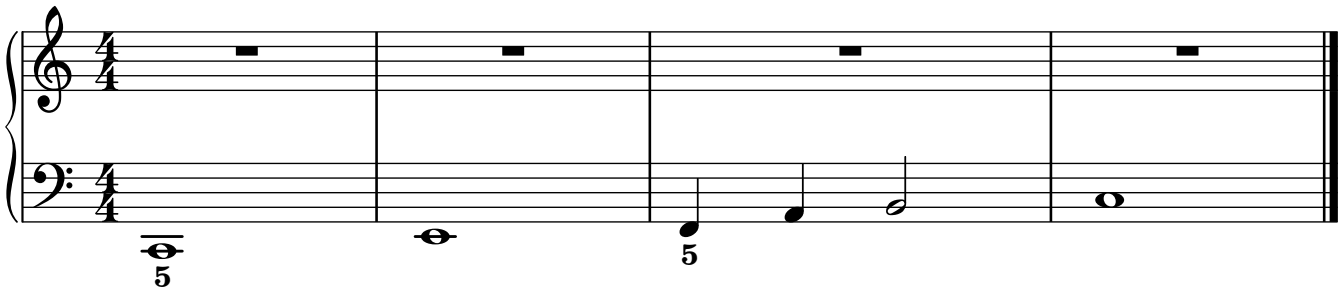
☐ **4.2**



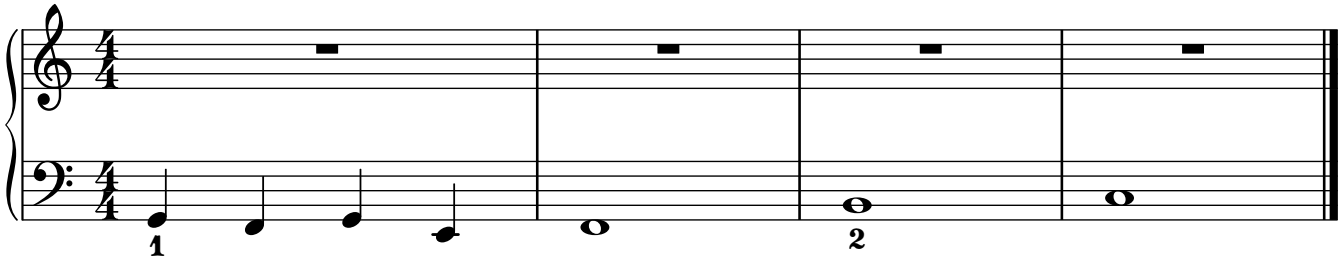
☐ **4.3**



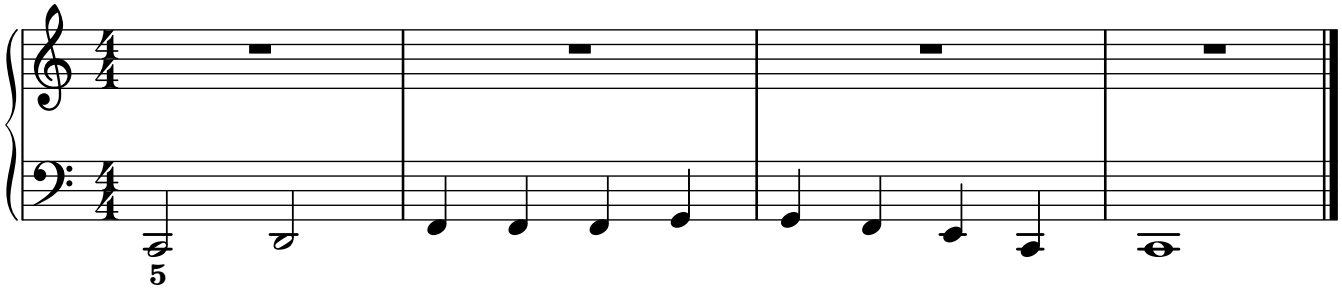
☐ **4.4**



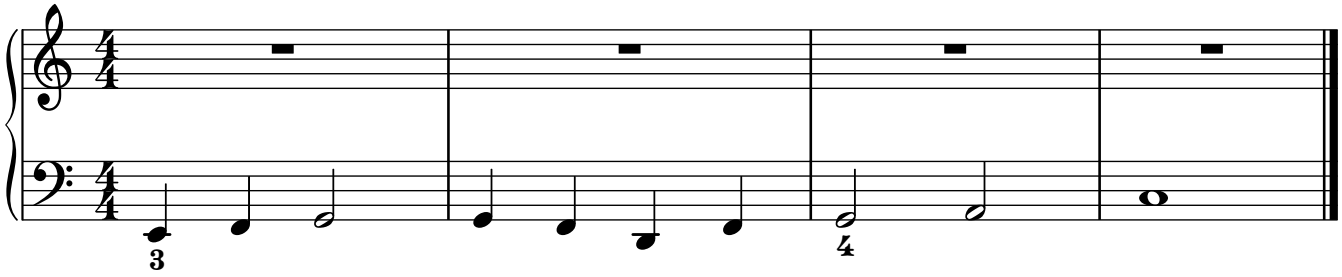
☐ **4.5**



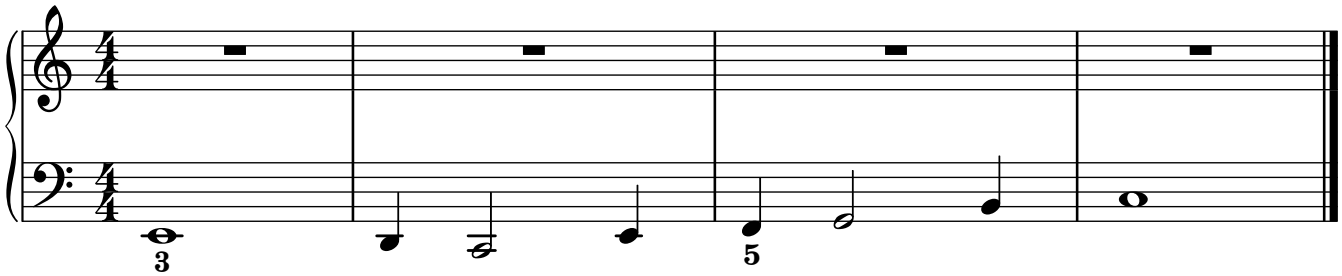
4.6



4.7



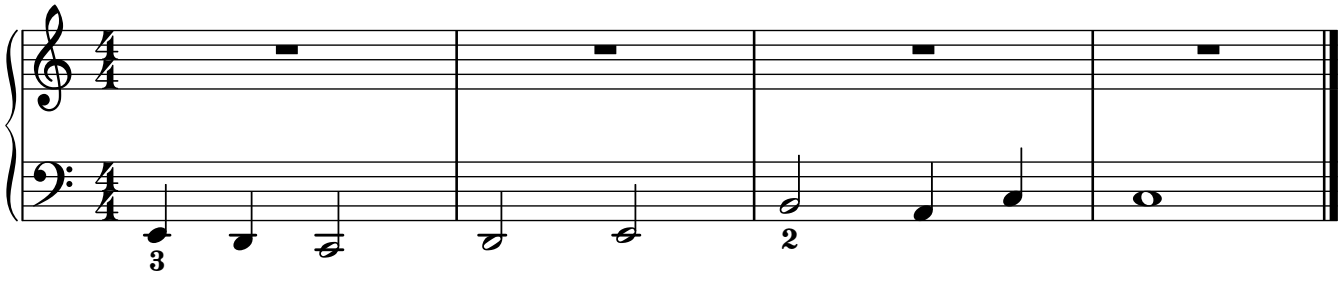
4.8



4.9



4.10



Part B: The tune in the bass, chords above

♩ = 80

F major: the tune in the left hand, low F position; the right hand plays chords on beats 2 and 4.

☐ **4.11**



☐ **4.12**



☐ **4.13**



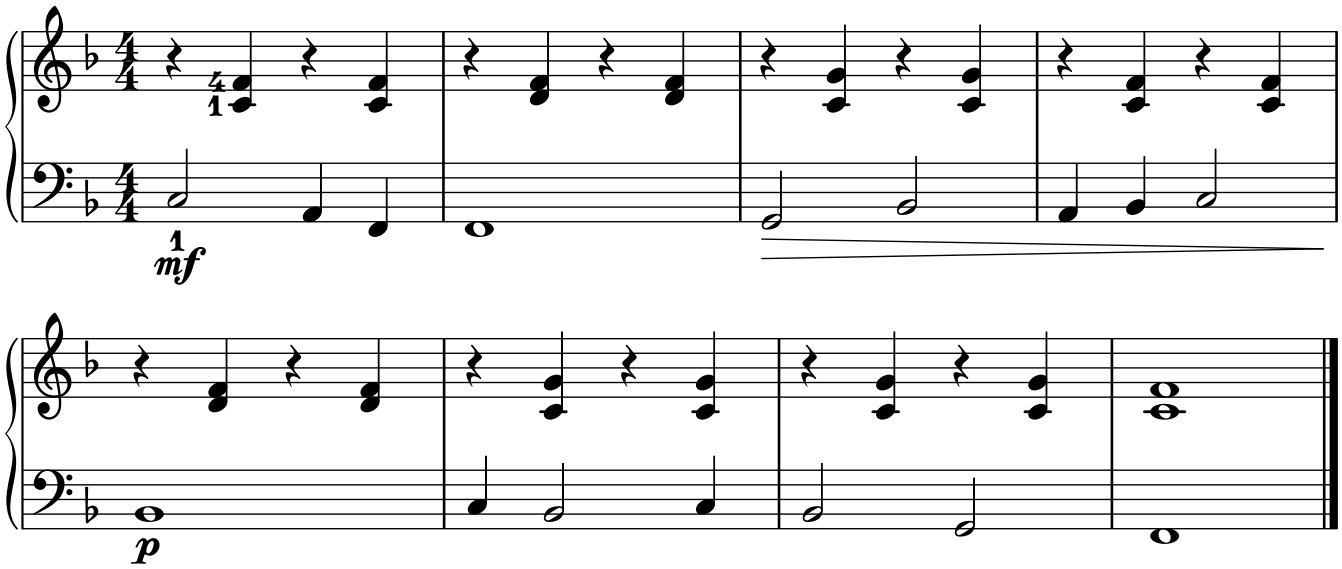
4.14



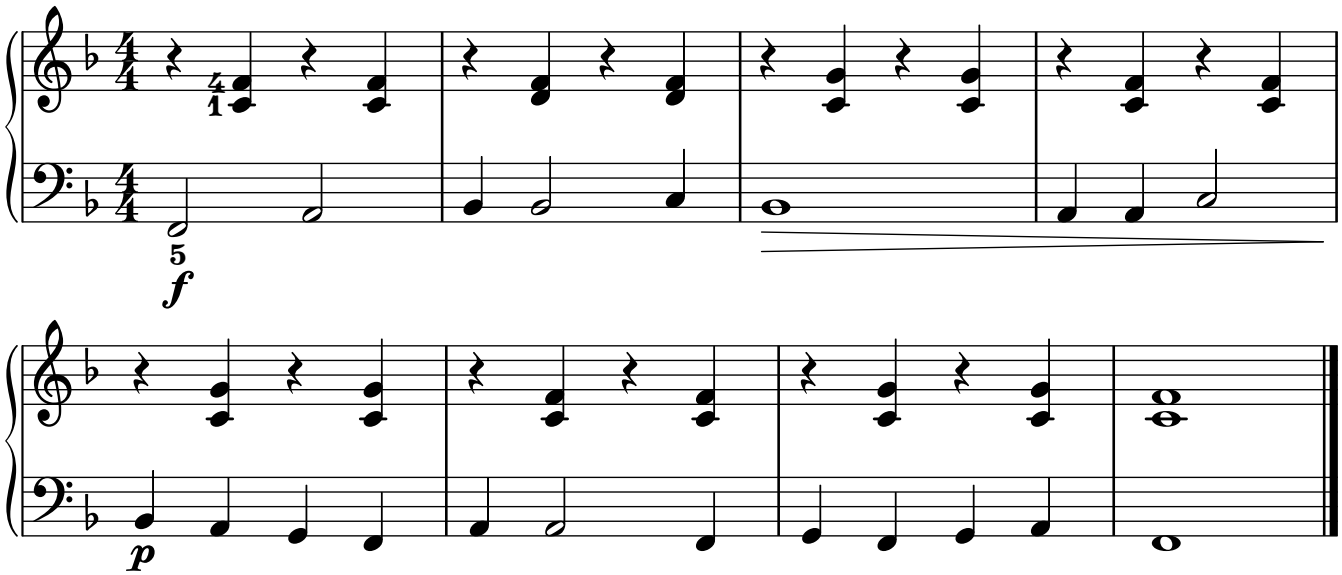
4.15



4.16



4.17



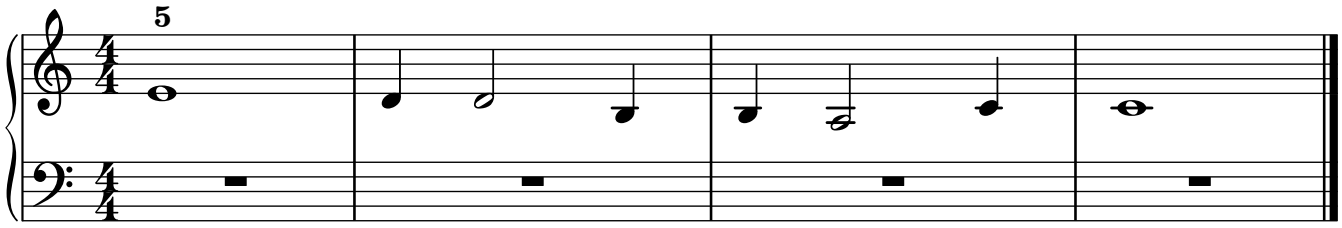
4.18



Part C: The right hand below middle C ♩ = 60

The right hand below middle C, from A3 up to E4.

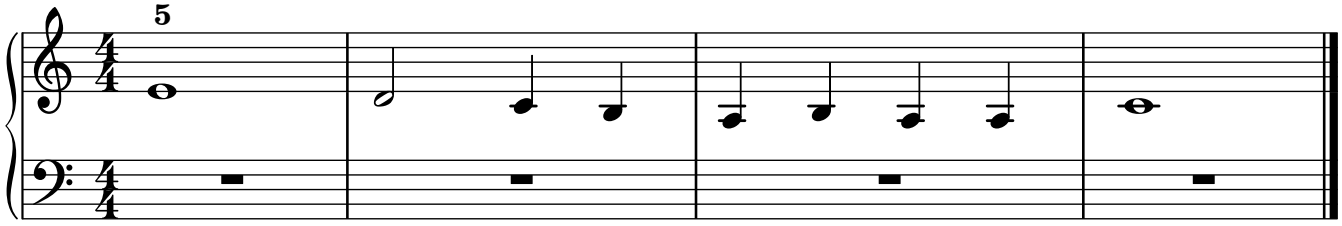
☐ **4.19**



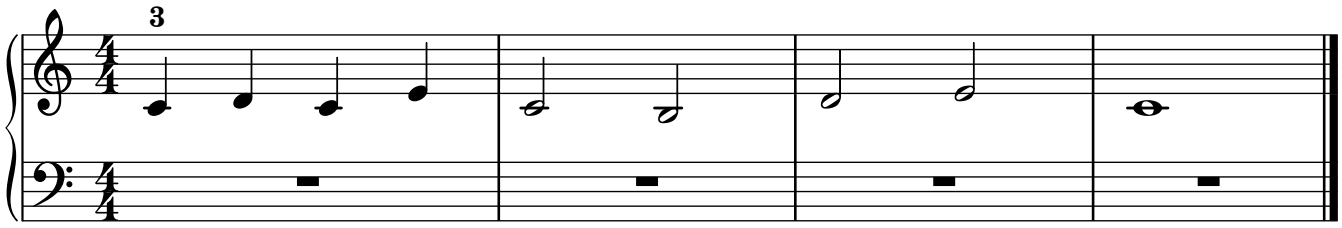
☐ **4.20**



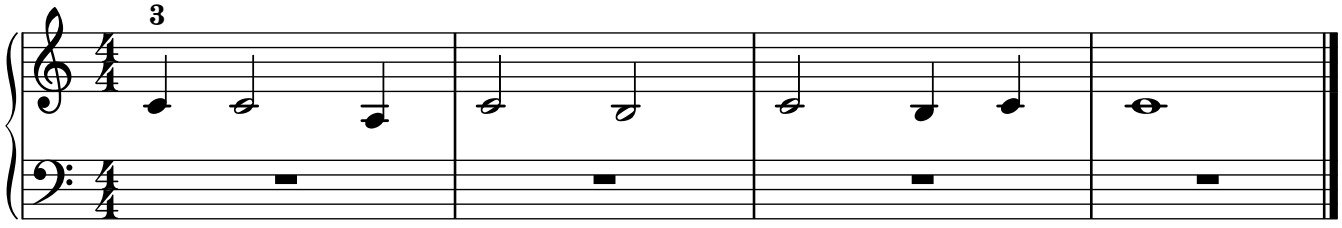
☐ **4.21**



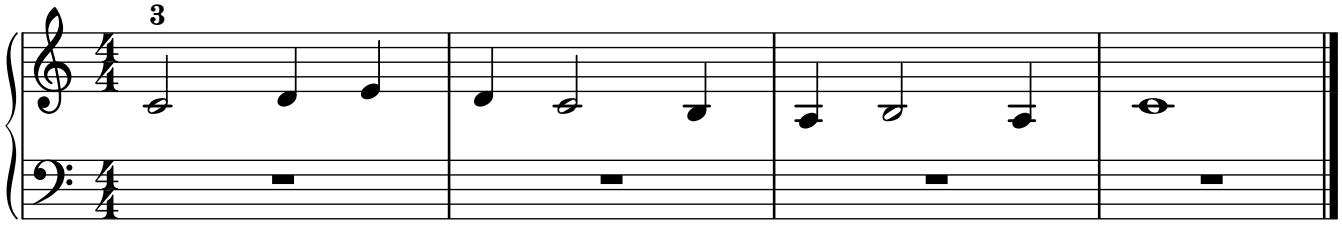
☐ **4.22**



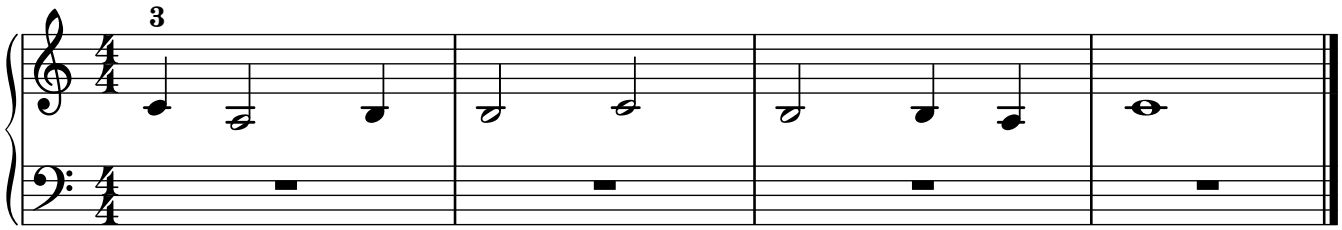
☐ **4.23**



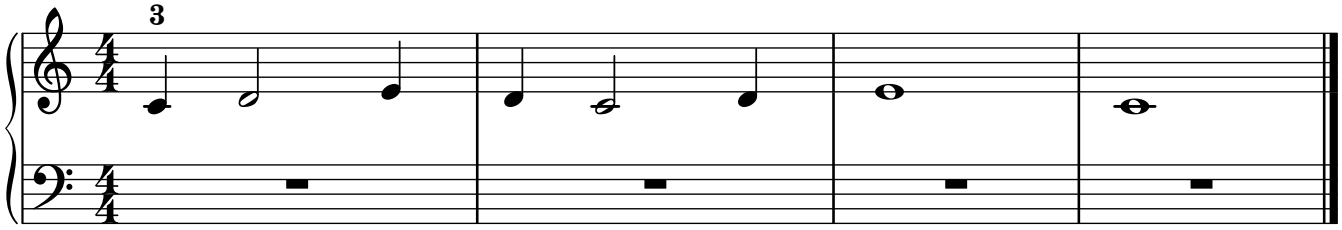
☐ **4.24**



4.25



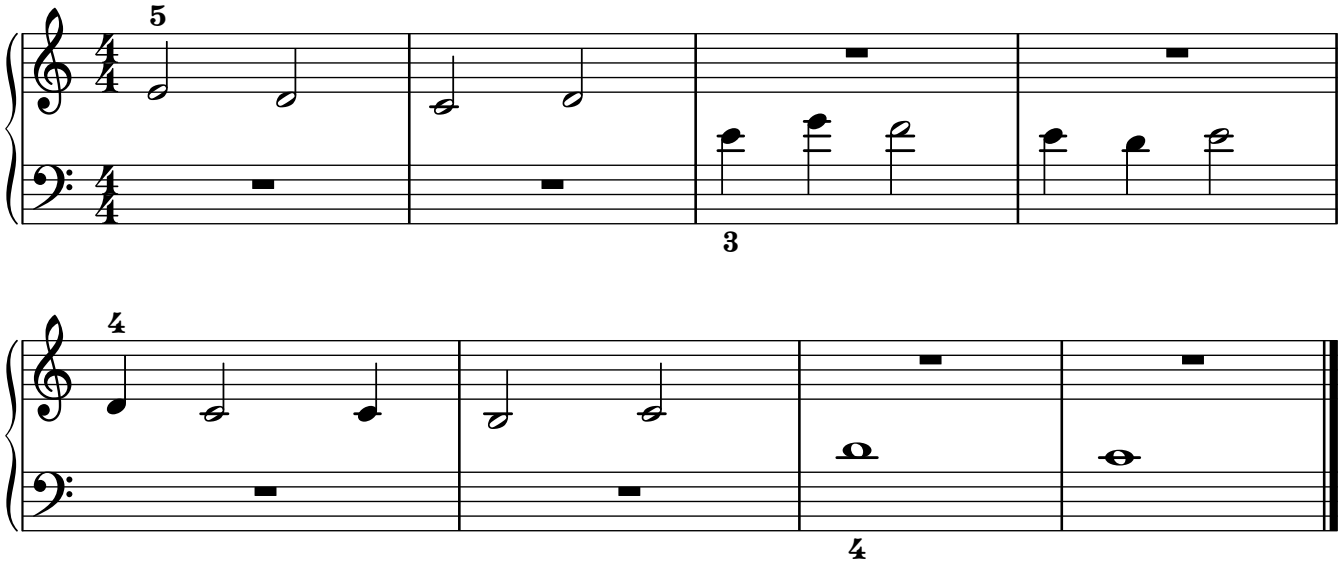
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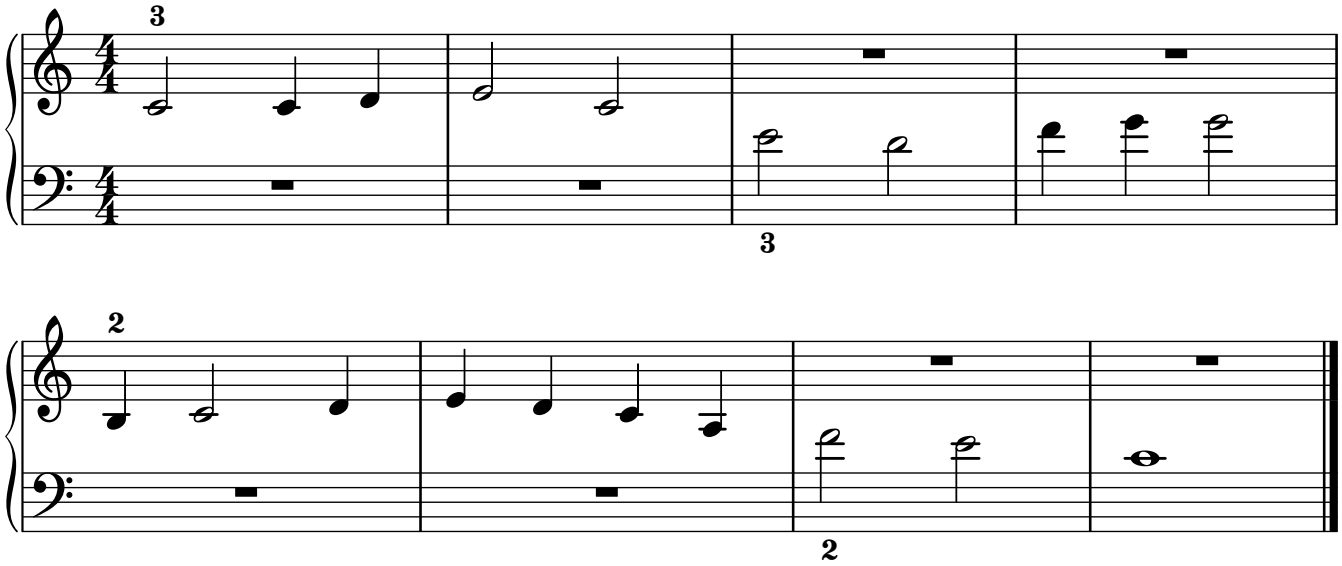
Part D: Both hands around middle C ♩ = 66

Both hands near middle C, taking turns: the right hand below it in the treble staff, the left hand above it in the bass staff.

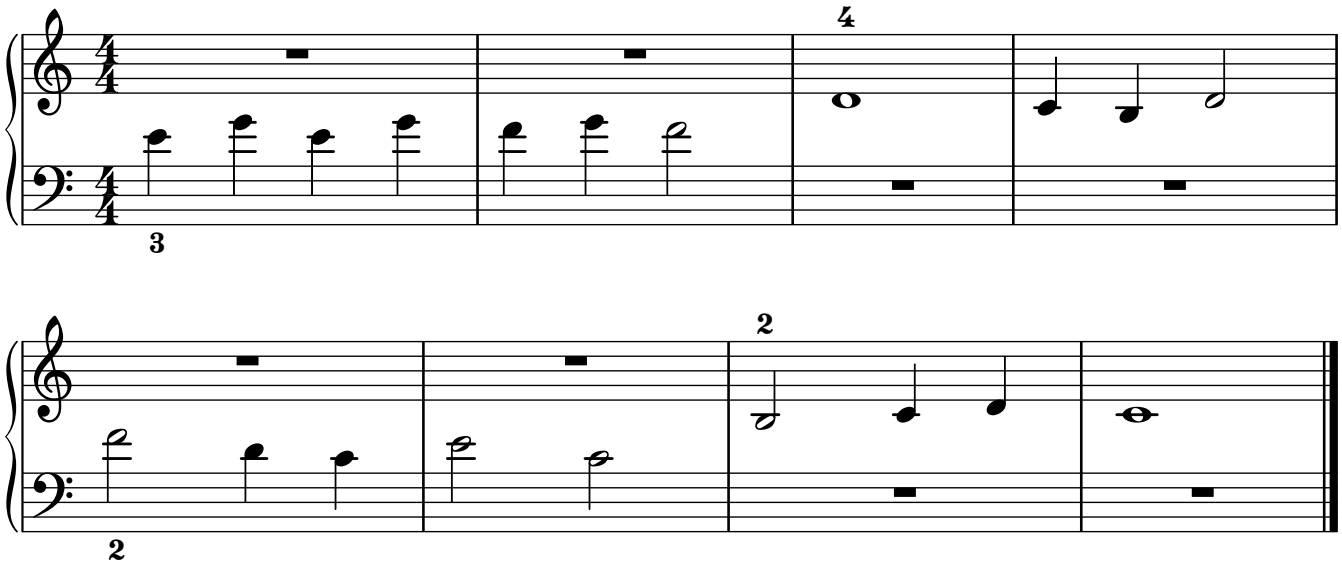
☐ **4.27**



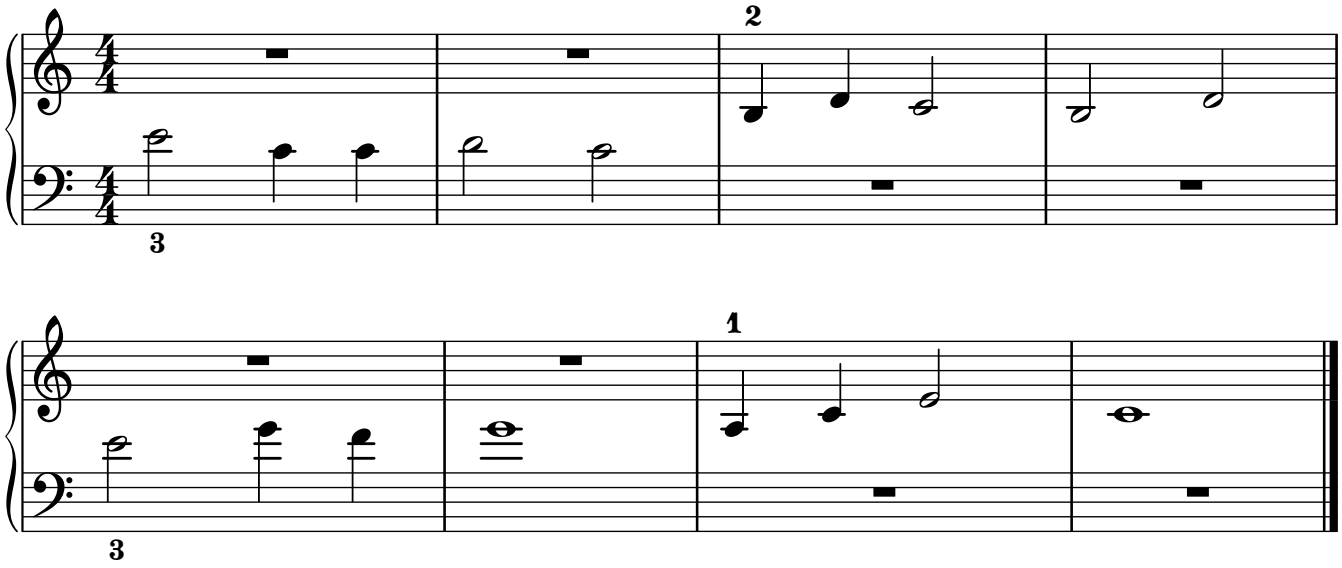
☐ **4.28**



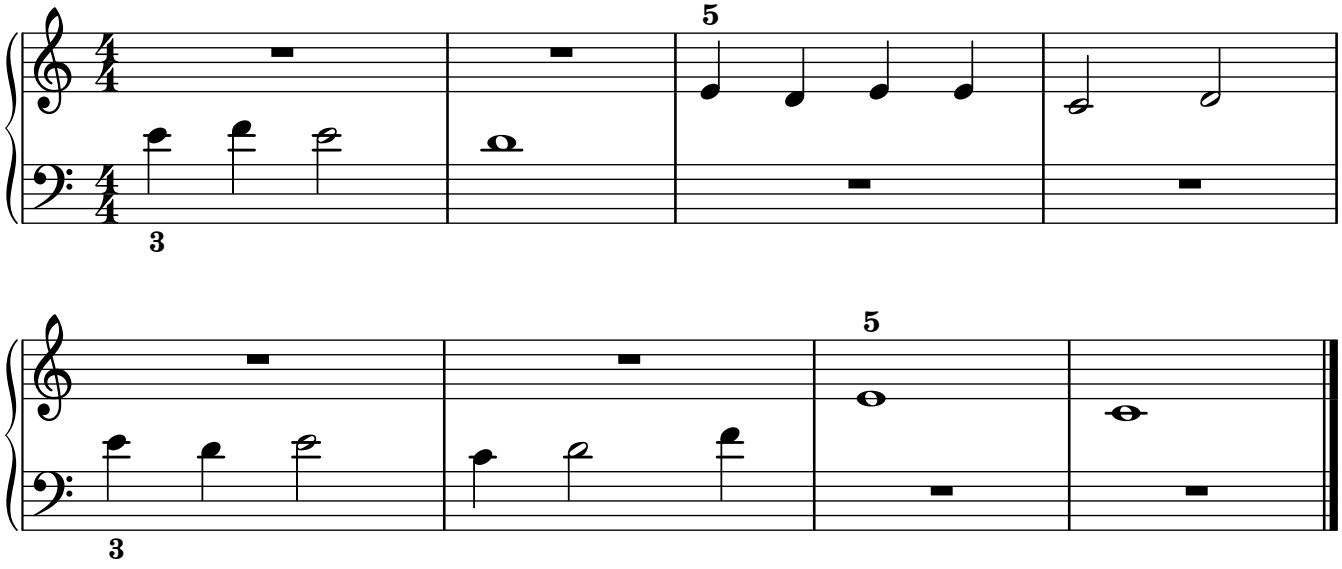
4.29



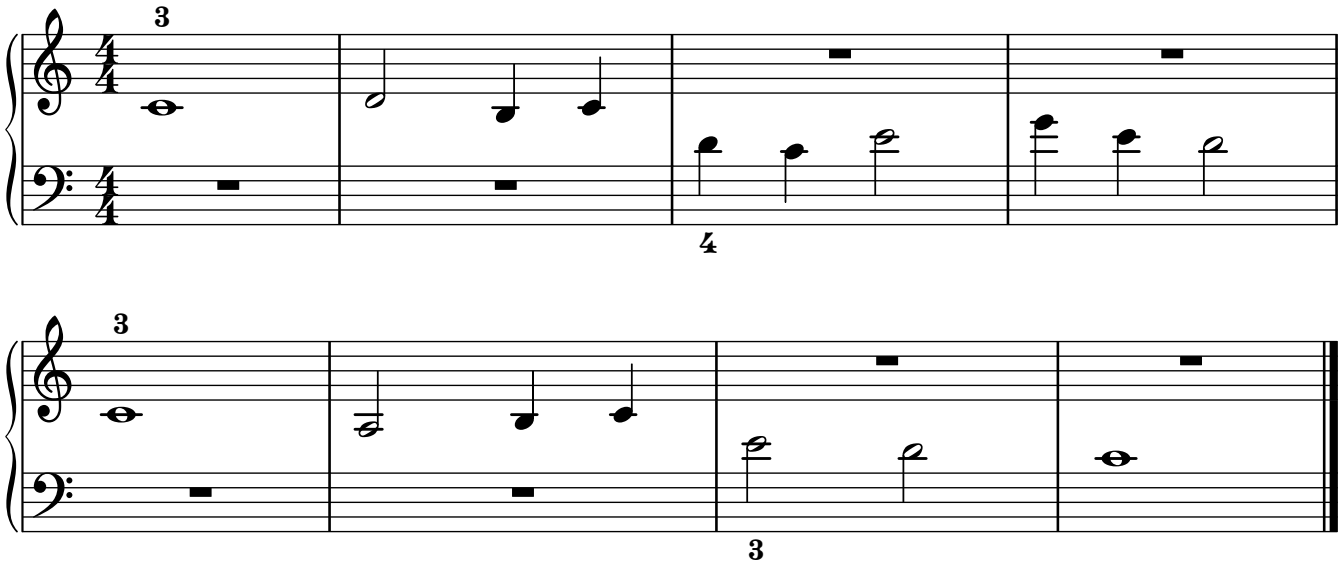
4.30



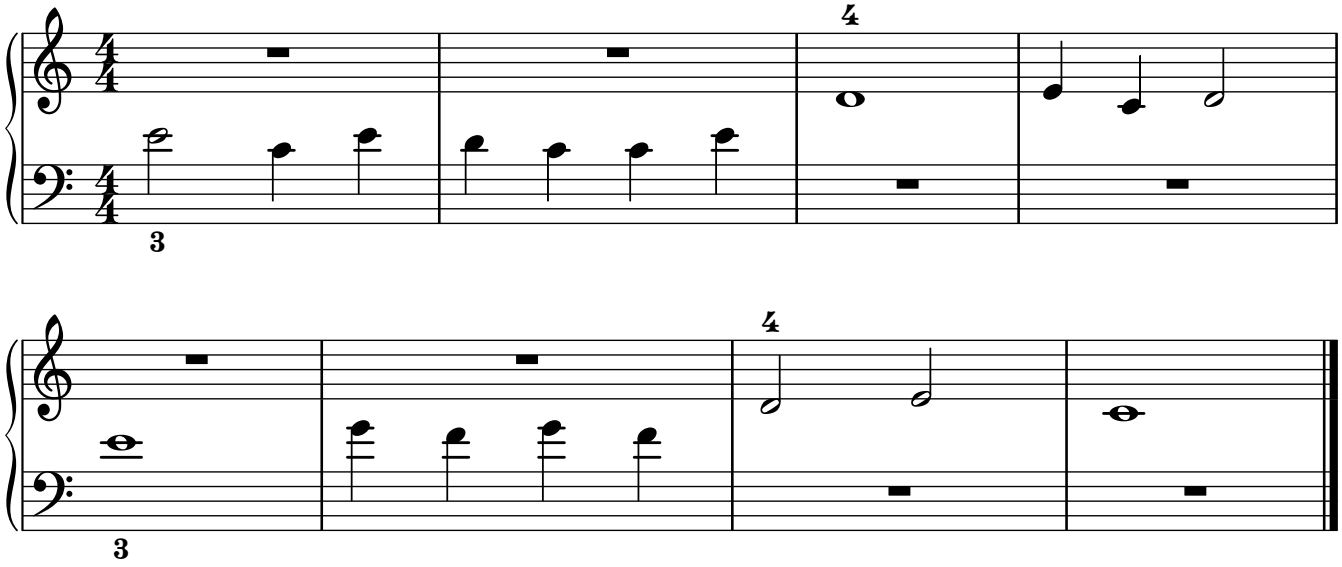
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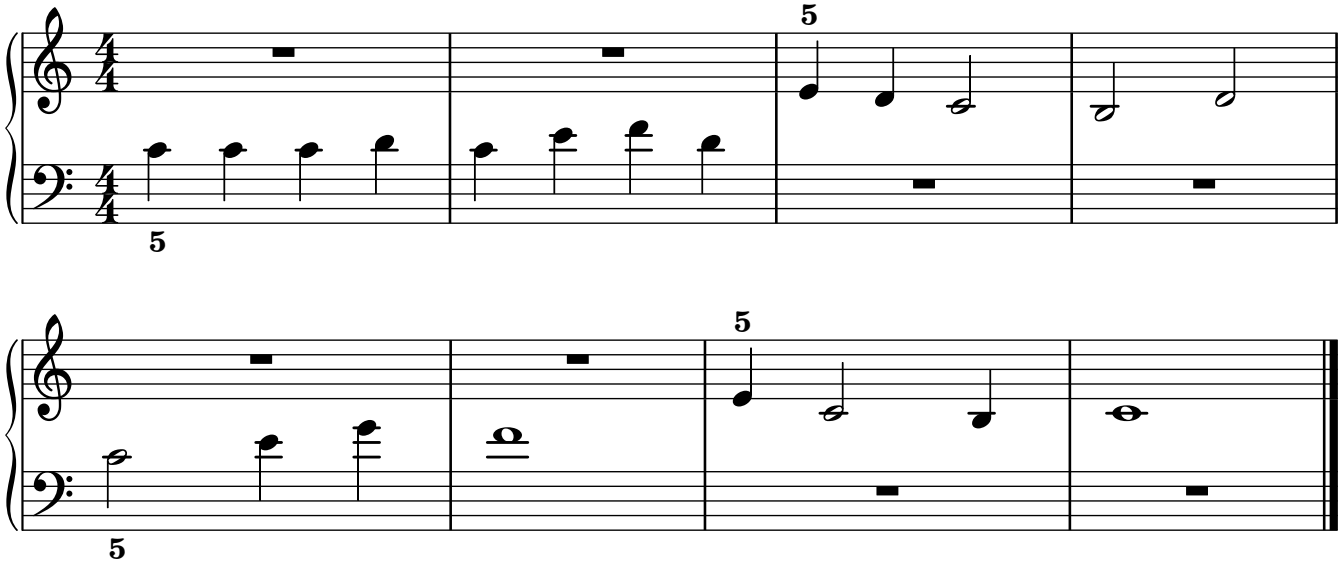
4.32



4.33



4.34



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

The Happy Farmer ♩ = 108

Robert Schumann, Op. 68 No. 10 (first part) - simplified

Schumann's farmer sings in the left hand, coming home from work; the right hand answers with short chords on the off-beats. The tune rises above the bass staff to F, on a ledger line. The opening upbeat is left out, and bars 3 and 7 use the same chord. Notes from Mutopia Project no. 659.



The Bear ♩ = 80

Original

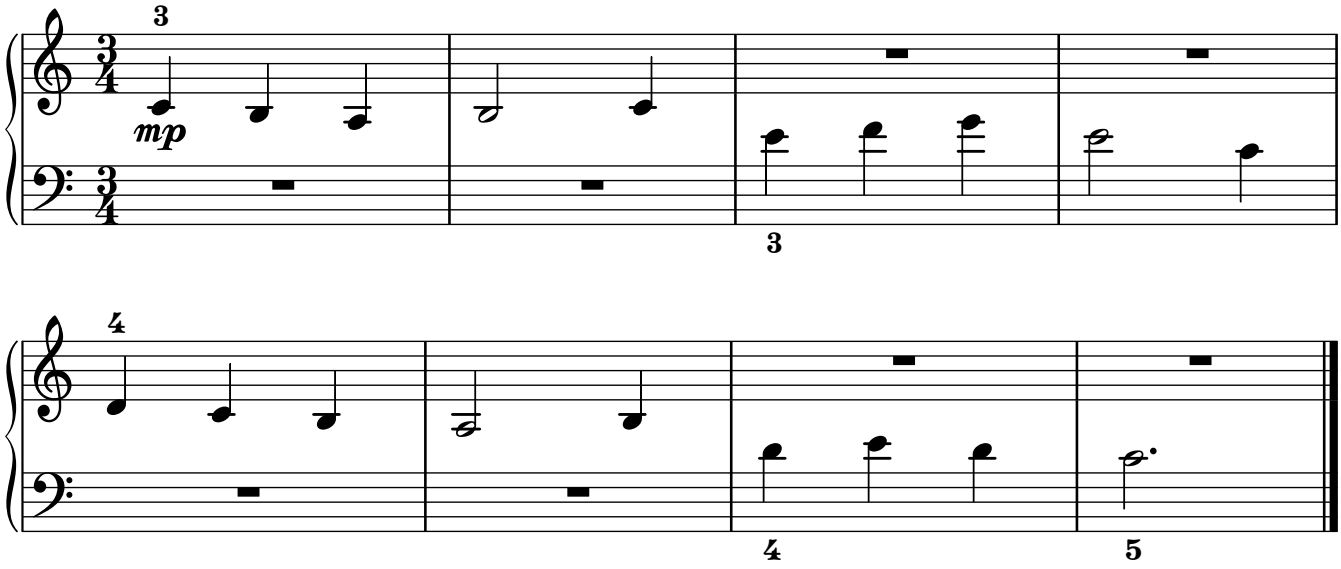
A heavy dance in low C position, C2 to G2, two ledger lines below the bass staff. The right hand plays chords on beats 2 and 4.



Meeting in the Middle ♩= 88

Original

The hands take turns around middle C. The right hand plays below it, in the treble staff; the left hand plays above it, in the bass staff, with up to three ledger lines.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 5?

- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Name any note from C2 up to G4 in the bass staff, and from A3 up in the treble staff, at a glance.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 5.